SERENE

AESTHETICS, WELLNESS AND IV INFUSION CENTER

FREE GUIDE

Smooth, Simple, Done: A Guide to Laser Hair Removal

How it works, who it suits, how many sessions to plan for, and what it really costs

SERENE MED SPA · PHYSICIAN-LED

Hudson, Ohio · Barboursville, West Virginia

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Inside this guide

Educational guide · not medical advice

01 How laser hair removal works

02 Who is a good candidate?

03 How to prepare (and what to skip)

04 What a session feels like

05 How many sessions, and how far apart

06 Aftercare and side effects

07 Doing the cost math

08 Popular treatment areas

09 Laser vs. other hair removal methods

10 What it costs at Serene

11 Your consultation checklist

12 Frequently asked questions

Shaving every morning. Booking a wax every few weeks. Ingrown hairs, razor bumps and that stubble that shows up by evening. If you are tired of the routine, laser hair removal is worth a close look.

Laser hair removal offers long-term hair reduction. That means fewer hairs, and the ones that grow back are often finer and lighter. It is not a one-visit fix, and it does not work the same for everyone. Knowing how it works helps you set realistic goals and plan your budget.

This guide walks you through the science in plain English, who tends to see good results, how to prepare, what sessions feel like, how many you may need, and how to do the cost math. Serene Med Spa is a physician-led med spa with offices in Hudson, Ohio and Barboursville, West Virginia, and we wrote this so you can walk into any consultation informed.

About Serene Med Spa

Serene is a physician-led med spa with offices in Hudson, Ohio and Barboursville, West Virginia, led by Robin Arora, MD and Shweta Arora, MD. We plan every treatment around your goals and health history, and we'll tell you plainly what a treatment can and can't do.

PART 01

How laser hair removal works

A laser sends pulses of light into the skin. The light is absorbed by melanin, the dark pigment in the hair and its root. The light turns into heat, and that heat damages the follicle, the tiny pocket in the skin that grows the hair. A damaged follicle grows hair more slowly, grows finer hair, or stops producing hair.

Hair grows in cycles. Only hairs in the active growing phase (called anagen) are still attached to the root, so they are the ones the laser can reach. At any moment, only part of your hair is in that phase. The rest are resting or shedding.

That is why one session is never enough. Each visit catches a new group of hairs as they move into the growing phase. A series of sessions, spaced a few weeks apart, is how you reach the most follicles over time.

> **The words that matter**
> Laser treatment offers long-term hair reduction, not a guarantee that every hair is gone. Many people see a large drop in hair over a series, and some need an occasional touch-up session later. Results vary.

PART 02

Who is a good candidate?

Because the laser looks for pigment, the key is contrast: hair that is darker than the skin around it. Dark, coarse hair usually responds most reliably.

Light blonde, red, gray and white hair have little or no usable pigment for the laser to absorb. These hair colors tend to respond poorly or not at all. If most of your unwanted hair is very light, ask about other options, such as electrolysis.

Skin tone matters too. Darker skin has more melanin, which can compete with the hair for the laser's energy. That raises the risk of burns or skin color changes if the wrong settings or device are used. Today, people with deeper skin tones can often be treated safely with the right technology, careful settings and an experienced team.

- Your skin type is usually rated on the Fitzpatrick scale (types I to VI), from very fair skin that always burns to deeply pigmented skin that rarely burns.
- Different laser wavelengths suit different skin types. Longer wavelengths (such as the diode and Nd:YAG lasers) are generally considered safer for deeper skin tones.
- In Hudson, laser hair removal is done with the InMode OptimasMAX (DiolazeXL, plus Fusion Light for fair to medium skin and Fusion Dark for coarse hair on deeper skin tones) and the Alma Harmony. Your provider chooses the device that suits your skin and hair.

- In Barboursville, the main device is the Alma Soprano ICE Platinum, a diode laser designed for a wide range of skin tones. DiolazeXL and Alma Harmony are also used for some areas.
- At both offices, your provider confirms your skin type and settings in person before treatment.

> **Sun and tanning**
> A tan adds pigment to your skin, which can raise the risk of side effects. Avoid tanning beds and heavy sun before and between sessions, and always tell your provider about recent sun exposure. Your settings may need to change, or your session may need to wait.

PART 03

How to prepare (and what to skip)

Good prep helps the laser do its job and lowers the chance of irritation. The most important rule surprises many people: shave, but do not wax or pluck.

- Shave the area 12 to 24 hours before your visit. This removes hair above the skin, so the laser energy goes to the root instead of burning on the surface.
- Do not wax, pluck, thread or use electrolysis for about 4 weeks before treatment. These remove the hair root, which is exactly what the laser needs to find.
- Stay out of the sun and avoid tanning beds. Use a broad-spectrum sunscreen with SPF 30 or higher on exposed areas.
- Skip self-tanner and spray tans on the treatment area. Self-tanner tints the skin and can interfere with treatment.
- Come with clean skin. Skip lotion, deodorant, makeup and perfume on the area that day.
- Tell us about your medications, any history of cold sores, keloid scars or pigment problems, and whether you are pregnant.

PART 04

What a session feels like

Most people describe each pulse as a quick snap, like a rubber band, or a brief warm feeling. Built-in cooling helps keep you comfortable. Areas with thick, dense hair, like the underarms or bikini line, may feel more intense at the first visits. As hair thins out, sessions often feel easier.

Everyone in the room wears eye protection. The laser light can injure the eyes, so you will wear special goggles or eye shields for the whole session. For the same reason, laser hair removal is not done on the eyelids, and areas near the eyes need extra care.

Sessions are quick. Small areas like the upper lip or underarms can take just a few minutes. Larger areas like the back or full legs with bikini take longer, often around half an hour. If you are a good candidate, treatment can often begin the same day as your consultation.

PART 05

How many sessions, and how far apart

Most people need a series of about 4 to 8 sessions. Some see good progress sooner, and some need more. Hormones, hair thickness, hair color, skin type and the body area all play a role. Areas with hormone-driven hair, such as the chin and neck, often need more sessions and more maintenance.

Spacing follows the hair growth cycle, which runs at different speeds in different places. These are common starting points; your provider will set your schedule.

- Face (upper lip, chin, sideburns, neck): often every 4 to 6 weeks
- Underarms and bikini or Brazilian: often every 6 to 8 weeks
- Arms, legs, back and chest: often every 6 to 8 weeks, sometimes longer as hair slows
- After your series: many people come back for an occasional maintenance session, often every 6 to 12 months

> **Between sessions**
> Shaving is fine. Do not wax, tweeze or thread. Treated hairs usually start to shed within 1 to 3 weeks. That shedding is normal and can look like regrowth at first.

PART 06

Aftercare and side effects

Mild redness, warmth, slight swelling and small bumps around the follicles are common right after treatment. It can feel like a mild sunburn. These effects usually settle within hours to a few days.

- First 24 to 48 hours: avoid hot tubs, saunas, steam rooms and very hot showers. Skip hard workouts and heavy sweating.
- Wear loose, breathable clothing over treated areas. Do not scratch, pick or exfoliate.
- Avoid perfumed lotions, retinoids, glycolic acid and harsh scrubs for several days. Gentle cleansers, moisturizer, aloe or a cool compress can soothe redness.
- Avoid direct sun for 1 to 2 weeks after each session and wear SPF 30+ daily. Keep avoiding tanning beds and self-tanner.
- Less common side effects include blistering, crusting, burns, and lightening or darkening of the skin. Most pigment changes fade with time, but some can last. Scarring is rare.
- In rare cases, hair can grow thicker near a treated area. Tell your provider if you notice this.

> **Call or text us if you notice**
> Blistering, severe swelling, signs of infection, a burn that is not healing, pain that gets worse, or a noticeable change in skin color. Our physician-led team wants to hear from you.

PART 07

Doing the cost math

Laser hair removal is priced per area, per session. To estimate your total, multiply the per-session price by the number of sessions you expect, then compare that with a package.

At both Serene offices, a 6-session package is priced as "buy 5, 6th free." In other words, the package costs the same as five single sessions. Since most people need a series anyway, a package is often the simpler way to budget.

- Underarms: $75 per session at both offices. Six single sessions would be $450; the 6-session package is $375.
- Full legs: $360 per session at both offices. Six single sessions would be $2,160; the package is $1,800.
- Brazilian: $89 per session ($445 for a 6-session package) at both offices.
- Upper lip: $75 per session at both offices, or $375 for the package.
- If you need 8 underarm sessions, plan on about $525: the $375 package plus two more sessions at $75 each.
- New clients: "20% off your first visit — applies to any product or service; can't be combined with another discount". For example, a single $75 underarm session would be $60. Ask how this works with a package, since discounts can't be combined.

> **Seasonal specials**
> Both offices run seasonal specials on laser hair removal from time to time. Ask about current offers when you book, or check serenemedspas.com/specials/.

PART 08

Popular treatment areas

Almost any area with dark, unwanted hair can be treated, except the eyelids and the area right around the eyes. These are the areas people ask about most.

- Face: upper lip, chin, sideburns, full face, and neck with beard line
- Underarms: one of the most popular areas, and one of the quickest
- Bikini line and Brazilian
- Arms (half or full), hands, shoulders
- Legs (lower, upper or full)
- Back, chest and stomach
- Smaller spots like the ears or areola
- Full body, for people who want one plan for everything

Laser vs. other hair removal methods

	Laser hair removal	Waxing	Shaving	Electrolysis
How it works	Light heats and damages the hair follicle	Pulls hairs out by the root	Cuts hair at the skin's surface	A fine probe and electric current treat one follicle at a time
How long smoothness lasts	Long-term hair reduction after a series; occasional touch-ups	About 3 to 6 weeks	1 to 3 days	Long-term results after a full series
Hair colors	Works on dark hair; poor on blonde, red, gray or white	All colors	All colors	All colors, including gray and white
Visits needed	About 4 to 8 sessions, weeks apart	Ongoing, every few weeks	Ongoing, at home	Many sessions, often over a year or more
How it feels	Quick snaps or warmth with cooling	Stinging as hair is pulled	Painless, but razor bumps are common	Stinging or heat with each follicle
Good fit for	Medium to large areas with dark hair	Short-term smoothness, any hair	Quick, low-cost upkeep	Small areas, light or gray hair
Cost pattern	Higher up front, then low upkeep	Repeats for as long as you wax	Low per use, but never ends	Priced by time; adds up for large areas

What it costs at Serene

Treatment	Hudson, OH	Barboursville, WV
Sideburns Per session / 6-session package	$59 / $295	$49 / $245
Upper lip Per session / 6-session package	$75 / $375	$75 / $375
Chin Per session / 6-session package	$99 / $495	$89 / $445
Full face Per session / 6-session package	$99 / $495	$129 / $645
Neck (+ beard line) Per session / 6-session package	$160 / $800	$160 / $800
Underarms Per session / 6-session package	$75 / $375	$75 / $375
Bikini line Per session / 6-session package	$69 / $345	$69 / $345
Brazilian Per session / 6-session package	$89 / $445	$89 / $445
Half arms Per session / 6-session package	$180 / $900	$180 / $900
Full arms Per session / 6-session package	$280 / $1,400	$280 / $1,400
Lower legs or upper legs Per session / 6-session package	$240 / $1,200	$240 / $1,200
Full legs Per session / 6-session package	$360 / $1,800	$360 / $1,800
Full back Per session / 6-session package	$310 / $1,550	$310 / $1,550
Chest + abdomen Per session / 6-session package	$310 / $1,550	$310 / $1,550
Full body Per session / 6-session package	$510 / $2,550	$500 / $2,500

Treatment	Hudson, OH	Barboursville, WV
6-session package terms Prepaid package; ask about seasonal specials	Buy 5, 6th free	Buy 5, 6th free

Prices as of October 2026; see serenemedspas.com for current pricing. Prices are starting points, and your exact plan and final pricing are confirmed at your consultation. Other areas (hands, ears, areola, stomach, shoulders) are listed on each office's pricing page.

Your consultation checklist

- [ ] What is my skin type, and which device and settings will you use for me?
- [ ] Is my hair color dark enough to respond well? If not, what are my other options?
- [ ] How many sessions do you expect I will need for each area, and how far apart?
- [ ] What is my total cost per area, and does a package make sense for me?
- [ ] Who will perform my treatment, and is a physician involved in my plan?
- [ ] Do you recommend a test spot before my first full session?
- [ ] Have I shared my medications, recent sun exposure, self-tanner use and history of cold sores or scarring?
- [ ] Have I stopped waxing and plucking at least 4 weeks before my first visit?
- [ ] What side effects should I watch for, and how do I reach you after treatment?
- [ ] When should I expect to need maintenance sessions?

Frequently asked questions

Will the hair be gone for good?

Laser offers long-term hair reduction, not a promise that every hair is gone. Most people see much less hair after a full series, and regrowth is often finer and lighter. Many people need an occasional maintenance session. Results vary.

Does it hurt?

Most people feel a quick snap or a warm sensation with each pulse. Built-in cooling helps. Sensitive areas with thick hair may feel more intense at first, and sessions often get easier as hair thins.

Can I shave between sessions?

Yes. Shaving is fine and is actually how you prepare. Avoid waxing, plucking, tweezing and threading, because they remove the root the laser needs to target.

Why does hair seem to grow back a week or two later?

Treated hairs often push out of the skin and shed over 1 to 3 weeks. It can look like regrowth, but it is usually the treated hair leaving. Do not pluck it.

Does laser work on blonde, red or gray hair?
Usually not well. The laser targets dark pigment, and these hair colors have little of it. Electrolysis treats each follicle directly and works on any hair color, so it can be a better fit for light hairs.

Can I get laser hair removal if I have darker skin?
Often, yes, with the right device and settings. Longer-wavelength lasers are generally considered safer for deeper skin tones. Your provider will confirm your skin type in person and adjust settings at each visit.

Is there downtime?
Usually no. Mild redness or bumps may last a few hours to a few days. Most people go right back to their day, while avoiding heat, hard workouts and sun for a short time.

Can I be treated if I am pregnant?
Most providers recommend waiting until after pregnancy. Hormone changes can also affect hair growth during this time. Let us know if you are pregnant or planning to be.

YOUR NEXT STEP

Ready when you are

- Book a consultation online: Hudson at https://serenemedspas.com/hudson/ or Barboursville at https://serenemedspas.com/barboursville/.
- Prefer to text? Hudson: (330) 303-2031. Barboursville: (304) 396-0295. Send us the areas you want treated and we can help you plan.
- Stop waxing and plucking now, so you are ready to start your series in about 4 weeks.
- New clients: "20% off your first visit — applies to any product or service; can't be combined with another discount".

Hudson, Ohio

50 W Streetsboro St, Suite 2
Text (330) 303-2031 · Call (330) 460-5915
serenemedspas.com/hudson

Barboursville, West Virginia

1 Chateau Grove Ln
Text (304) 396-0295 · Call (304) 520-0461
serenemedspas.com/barboursville

Scan a code to see pricing and book online.

Important

This guide is for general education only and is not medical advice. It does not replace a consultation with a licensed medical provider. Laser hair removal offers long-term hair reduction, but results vary from person to person, and no specific outcome is promised. Session counts and spacing shown are general ranges, and your provider will recommend a plan based on your skin, hair and health. Prices are as of October 2026 and may change; see serenemedspas.com for current pricing. If you have a medical emergency, call 911.

Sources

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